The Commons — Business Plan

April 2026 | Prepared by Carrie Ann Kidd | Harmony for Hope, Inc.
Contact: hh4hwv2011@gmail.com | Mount Hope, West Virginia

Table of Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Opportunity — Problem Worth Solving
3. Our Solution
4. Target Market
5. Competition
6. Execution — Marketing Plan
7. Sales Plan
8. Locations & Facilities
9. Technology
10. Milestones & Key Metrics
11. Barriers to Entry
12. Company — Ownership & Structure
13. Management Team & Advisors
14. Financial Plan

Executive Summary

The Commons is the daily-life community platform of the MountainShares ecosystem — the governed shared space where Appalachian residents, local businesses, government agencies, and university partners interact, contribute, and earn recognition for the work that holds communities together. It is not a social media platform. It is a **community infrastructure** designed with the same care for safety, accountability, and community sovereignty that shapes every other component of the MountainShares system.

The Commons sits at the intersection of three layers: MountainShares is the economic instrument, Ms. Jarvis is the analytical intelligence, and The Commons is the **human interface** — the place where those two systems become visible and usable in daily life. It makes governable the invisible social labor of Appalachian communities — caregiving, mutual aid, cultural preservation, and civic contribution — and routes the value generated by that labor back into the communities that produced it.

Operating under the nonprofit umbrella of Harmony for Hope, Inc. (H4H), a West Virginia 501(c)(3) based in Mount Hope, The Commons is the community-facing product that brings the MountainShares closed-loop economy into everyday reach. Its phased rollout begins with a Phase 0 invite-only beta in Fayette County, anchored at the Fayette County Community Arts Center and the 704 Main Street facility in Mount Hope.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

The Commons is funded through the same hybrid model as MountainShares: a documented $796,200 founder's in-kind investment, targeted federal and foundation grants, and a self-sustaining

fee engine once the system reaches Phase 1 commerce.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Opportunity

Problem Worth Solving

1. Community Labor Is Invisible and Unrewarded
Traditional markets ignore caregiving, mutual aid, heritage preservation, and civic contribution. These are the acts that hold Appalachian communities together, but they generate no recognized economic value, no credit, and no path to governance standing. The result is a community-wide **reciprocity deficit**: the people doing the most essential work have the least economic and political voice.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

2. Platforms Extract Rather Than Reciprocate
Every major platform Appalachian residents currently use — Facebook Marketplace, Amazon, Venmo — extracts behavioral data, attention, and transaction fees without reinvesting in the community. There is no community-governed alternative: a platform built for a specific place, accountable to the people who use it, and designed to keep the value it generates in the region where it is created.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

3. Public Benefits Create a Participation Trap
Many West Virginians rely on SSI, SNAP, Medicaid, and other means-tested assistance. Most digital platforms ignore how participation — earning rewards, holding balances, or receiving recognition — can inadvertently count toward income or asset limits, putting essential benefits at risk. This "iron cage" of public benefits is one of the primary reasons vulnerable residents are systematically excluded from the digital economy.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

4. Governance Power Is Purchased, Not Earned
In most platforms and most local systems, influence is bought with financial stake. Those who do the most community work — often the most economically precarious residents — have the least say. The Commons is built on the inverse principle: governance standing is earned through documented contribution, not purchased with wealth.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

5. Local Data Decays and Disappears
Rural community data — business hours, food pantry availability, clinic locations, trail conditions — decays rapidly in global databases and is rarely verified by people who actually use the services. Communities have no governed mechanism to maintain their own information layer, ensure its accuracy, or use it to make better decisions.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Our Solution

The Commons directly addresses each of these problems by providing a governed, place-specific, community-owned platform with five core capabilities:

1. The Daily Life Game — Making Invisible Labor Visible
The Commons' primary engagement layer is the Daily Life Game, which assigns EMS (Earned MountainShares) rewards to everyday acts of community contribution: caregiving check-ins, mutual

aid fulfillment, heritage documentation, quest completion, event attendance, and civic participation. These acts are logged permanently in the recognition ledger. Community members advance through ranks — Newcomer → Bronze → Silver → Gold → Champion → Elder — based exclusively on documented hours of contribution, unlocking governance rights and economic standing as they go.

2. A Hyperlocal Marketplace — The Commons App
The Commons evolves through three stages from a neighbor-to-neighbor barter board into a full-scale local commerce engine. In Phase 0 it is a quest-and-contribution platform. In Phase 1 it opens local commerce: participants can spend EMS at MountainShares merchants, discover local businesses, and engage with community events. In Phase 2 it becomes a full marketplace where Appalachian goods and services are available to both local residents and the West Virginia diaspora.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

3. Benefits-Sensitive Architecture
Every account created in The Commons is evaluated at onboarding for Benefits Sensitivity. Benefits-Sensitive Account (BSA) holders receive hard balance caps, earning throttles, and "fail-safe" protections that prevent participation from inadvertently triggering benefit loss. The BSA architecture is the most specialized component of The Commons and represents a significant competitive barrier to entry: no other platform has designed these protections for Appalachian benefit recipients.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

4. Ground-Truthed Local Data Layer
The Commons is the human interface for the Ms. Jarvis GeoBelief Information Model (GBIM), which holds 5.4 million verified local beliefs and 45GB of PostGIS spatial data specific to West Virginia. Community Champions physically verify food pantries, resource locations, trail conditions, and business data — ensuring that the system's "intelligence with a ZIP code" is grounded in real, current, local evidence rather than decaying global datasets.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

5. Governed Participation, Not Passive Consumption
The Commons is a **governed community infrastructure**. Governance rights are earned through the Contribution Game — participants who log documented hours of community labor advance through ranks that unlock the ability to propose new rules, vote on governance proposals, and help steward the commons. The "one-UEI-one-vote" principle ensures that no financial stake can purchase extra influence.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Target Market

The Commons serves the same three primary segments as MountainShares, with specific platform roles for each:

Individual Residents and Families — the core participant base. This includes residents who contribute community labor (caregiving, education, mutual aid, heritage preservation) and want recognition and economic standing for that work. A critical sub-segment is Benefits-Sensitive Account holders on SSI, SNAP, and Medicaid, who require specialized protections to participate safely.

Local Small Businesses (Merchants) — the "economic anchors" who accept MountainShares in exchange for goods and services, participate in Commons quests and seasonal campaigns, and drive

local currency circulation. Merchants gain access to a customer base actively incentivized to shop local and earn M$ rewards for doing so.

Institutional Partners (University and Government Commons Nodes) — universities, colleges, county commissions, state agencies, and federal entities (including the National Park Service in Thurmond) who operate Commons Nodes to host data, support research and teaching, and connect institutional resources to community need — at no direct financial cost during defined phases.

Market Size and Growth

The Commons follows the same phased growth model as MountainShares:

- **Phase 0 (Pilot):** 25–100 invite-only participants; 5–15 merchants; anchored in Fayette County at the FCCAC and 704 Main Street.
- **Phase 1 (County Scale):** 500–2,000 active participants; 30–75 merchants; full Fayette County rollout.
- **Phase 2 (Regional Corridor):** 15,000–40,000 participants; 300–800 merchants; New River Gorge corridor and southern WV.
- **Phase 3 (Statewide and Diaspora):** 200,000–400,000 participants; up to 8,000 merchants; WV diaspora engaged through the USD storefront and Appalachian Premium goods layer.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Competition

The Commons does not face a direct competitor offering an equivalent governed, benefits-sensitive, place-based community platform. Its competitive landscape is:

Facebook Marketplace and Meta Products — the incumbent for neighbor-to-neighbor exchange and community discourse. They are efficient but extract behavioral data and attention without local reinvestment, have no benefits-sensitive protections, and provide no governance standing to users.

Nextdoor — the closest analog for neighborhood-scale community platforms. It lacks any economic layer, benefits protections, or governance mechanism. It is also "placeless" in its AI and moderation architecture.

Generic Loyalty and Rewards Apps — these reward spending but not contribution. They have no mutual-credit layer, no governance mechanism, and no place-specific intelligence.

Informal Community Networks (Facebook Groups, Group Chats) — widely used and resilient but ungoverned, data-unsafe, and unable to provide economic recognition for community labor or protections for benefits-sensitive participants.

The Commons Advantage:

- The only platform that monetizes invisible community labor through EMS.
- The only platform with purpose-built Benefits-Sensitive Account architecture for Appalachian benefit recipients.
- The only platform where governance standing is earned through contribution, not purchased.

- The only platform governed by a local nonprofit and grounded in verified, locally-maintained spatial data.

Execution

Marketing Plan

The Commons reaches its audience through the same "ground-truth first" strategy as MountainShares:

Physical and Heritage Discovery: The Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail, QR code markers at community sites, and the FCCAC serve as tangible entry points where residents encounter The Commons in the places they already use. Seasonal campaigns — Harvest Heritage Week, Spring Trail Mapping Drives — embed The Commons into the rhythms of Appalachian community life.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Digital Outreach: The Commons app is the central interface, evolving from a quest-and-barter board to a full commerce engine. A specialized USD Storefront targets the 200,000+ West Virginia diaspora, allowing out-migrants to support home communities by purchasing authentic WV-made goods.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Community Champions: Trusted local residents perform "ground-truthing," verify local data, and serve as the primary onboarding force. They are the human layer that makes The Commons trustworthy in communities with valid, earned reasons to distrust distant technical systems.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Ms. Jarvis as Narrator: The AI Steward surfaces available quests, explains rewards and safety triggers in plain, warm language, and provides specialized "Plain Language Notices" for Benefits-Sensitive Account holders.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Institutional Partnerships: Government and University Commons Node partners create "anchor" relationships with institutions that communities already trust — county commissions, libraries, universities, clinics, and the National Park Service.

Sales Plan — The Onboarding Process

Onboarding follows the same staged, relationship-driven protocol as MountainShares:

Step 1: Identity Recognition. New participants receive a private, immutable Wallet ID and a governable public UUID. Identity verification (KYC) is appropriate to the user's risk tier and role.

Step 2: Benefits Sensitivity Assessment. Every new account is evaluated for BSA eligibility at onboarding. BSA holders are flagged immediately and protected by hard caps and earning throttles before they engage with the EMS or commerce layers.

Step 3: Red-Team Onboarding (Phase 0). The first participants are researchers, Community Champions, merchants, and institutional partners who serve as "conscious testers" to identify failure modes before the system opens to the public.

Step 4: Merchant Integration. Local businesses are onboarded with zero-cost entry, listed in the Commons directory, and integrated into quests and seasonal campaigns that drive M$-denominated foot traffic.

Step 5: Institutional Node Agreements. Government and University Commons Nodes are formalized through MOUs and Data Sharing Agreements, giving institutional partners a structured, legally clear relationship with The Commons without relinquishing control of their own data.

Locations & Facilities

The Commons is physically anchored at **704 Main Street, Mount Hope, West Virginia 25880** — the same facility as Harmony for Hope, Inc. and the backbone hardware for the ALLIS mesh intelligence nodes.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

The first proof-of-concept deployment is the **Fayette County Community Arts Center (FCCAC)** in Mount Hope — a public-facing community institution where the first "internet bubble" will demonstrate that community-owned broadband and local data caching can work in a real Appalachian setting. From there, the same pattern extends into Thurmond and the New River Gorge corridor, with Commons Nodes at gateway hamlets and eventual regional stewardship hubs at colleges, libraries, and clinics.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Technology

The Commons is built on the MountainShares "civilizational stack" and adds the following specific components:

The Commons App: The primary human interface, built with FastAPI/Uvicorn microservice architecture. Evolves through three stages: barter board → local commerce → full regional marketplace.

Ms. Jarvis (AI Steward): Orchestrates over 105 containerized services, provides "intelligence with a ZIP code" grounded in 5.4 million verified local beliefs, enforces constitutional safety triggers, and narrates the platform in plain Appalachian English.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Gamification Engine: The Daily Life Game assigns EMS rewards to documented community acts. The Contribution Game maps those acts onto rank progression and governance standing. Together they constitute the platform's engagement, retention, and governance infrastructure.

ALLIS Mesh Nodes: Locally-hosted mesh nodes provide maps, safety data, and AI-assisted support on-site, remaining operational during internet outages and in connectivity deserts like the New River Gorge corridor.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Benefits-Sensitive Account (BSA) Architecture: Hard balance caps, earning throttles, and eligibility-gated exchange rules that ensure participation does not inadvertently trigger benefit loss for SSI, SNAP, or Medicaid recipients.

Security: ML-DSA-65 post-quantum cryptographic signatures on all AI decisions; a "Blood-Brain Barrier" gateway with six simultaneous filters; all decisions logged to jarvis-memory:8056 for community-auditable accountability.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Open-Source and Licensing: The Commons platform components are made available under a community-governed open-source license. The underlying Ms. Jarvis / ALLIS infrastructure is owned by Kidd's Technical Services (KTS) and licensed to H4H under a non-exclusive, royalty-free community-benefit license.

Milestones & Key Metrics

Milestones

Phase	Target Date	Milestone
Phase 0	Q2–Q3 2026	FCCAC proof-of-concept live; 25–100 invite-only participants; red-team onboarding complete
Phase 0 → 1	Q4 2026	Pre-launch audit report; Founding badges issued; BSA architecture validated
Phase 1	Q1–Q2 2027	Public launch in Fayette County; 500–2,000 active participants; 30–75 merchants
Phase 1 → 2	Q4 2027	Hardware procurement complete; Thurmond node live; first government/university MOU signed
Phase 2	2028	Regional corridor rollout; 15,000+ participants; 300+ merchants; full Commerce layer live

Key Metrics

- **Currency Velocity:** ≥1.0 in Year 1; ≥2.0 long-term (how often M$ changes hands monthly).
- **Commons Work Hours Funded:** 10,000 verified hours/month by Year 5 — caregiving, mutual aid, education, cultural preservation.
- **BSA Participation Rate:** ≥30% of onboarded participants complete BSA eligibility review.
- **Ground-Truthed Place Records:** ≥5,000 verified records; ≥65% verified within last 12 months.

- **New User Activation:** ≥60% of new signups complete first quest and transaction within 14 days.
- **Institutional MOUs:** ≥10 anchor organization agreements by Phase 2.
- **Governance Quorum:** 30–40% of eligible voters participate in key economic and constitutional proposals.

Barriers to Entry

Deep Human Infrastructure: Community Champions, Captains, and Elders are earned through multi-year commitments to documented community labor. This human layer cannot be bought or replicated by an outside competitor.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Benefits-Sensitive Architecture: Building BSA protections that actually work for Appalachian benefit recipients requires deep regional policy expertise, legal counsel, and community trust built over years. No tech-first competitor has this.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Proprietary Place-Based Intelligence: Ms. Jarvis's 5.4-million-belief GBIM and 45GB PostGIS database, grounded in verified WV-specific data, cannot be replicated without years of local data collection and community verification.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

First-Mover Institutional Relationships: Government and University Commons Node partnerships, once formalized through MOUs and Data Sharing Agreements, create durable institutional anchors that new entrants cannot easily displace.

Earned Governance Standing: Governance rights in The Commons are earned through documented contribution, creating a deeply-rooted governance layer that prioritizes long-term community members over any external actor with financial resources.

Company — Ownership & Structure

The Commons is a program of **Harmony for Hope, Inc. (H4H)**, a West Virginia 501(c)(3) nonprofit corporation based in Mount Hope. It is governed by the same dual-layered nonprofit/DAO hybrid structure as MountainShares:MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

- **Nonprofit Umbrella (H4H):** Legal and regulatory "safety envelope," managing bank relationships, contracts, and compliance.
- **MountainShares DAO:** Participatory governance layer where community members earn voting rights through documented work — one-UEI-one-vote.
- **Asset Ownership:** The underlying Commons platform, ALLIS nodes, and Ms. Jarvis system are owned by Kidd's Technical Services (KTS) and licensed to H4H on a non-exclusive, royalty-free community-benefit basis.

The founder, Carrie Ann Kidd, has contributed **5,308 hours of senior technical labor valued at $796,200** as a non-dilutable in-kind capital contribution, establishing governance authority and veto power over proposals that would dilute the platform's commons principles.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Management Team & Advisors

Carrie Ann Kidd (Mamma Kidd) — Founder & Primary Architect
Senior geospatial systems architect; M.A. in Leadership; 10+ years PostGIS, microservices, and AI orchestration; PALCO/Medicaid Waiver caregiver experience directly informing BSA architecture; lead architect of the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail and H4H regional arts programming.

Crystal Colyer — Lead Validator, Community Champion
Boone County resident and boots-on-the-ground validator managing verification of food pantries and resource locations across multiple counties.

Dr. Anurag Srivastava — Technical Advisor, WVU
Raymond J. Lane Professor and Chair, Lane Department of CSEE, West Virginia University; Senior Scientist, Pacific Northwest National Laboratory; provides technical oversight on infrastructure stress, grid resilience, and AI validation methodology.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Taryn Mosser — GIS Advisor
State of West Virginia GIS Coordinator; guides integration of state-scale spatial data including E-911 address layer and tax parcel data.

Brandon Thompson — Starry Eyes Media
Strategic media and narrative support; ensures The Commons communicates in an authentic, culturally resonant Appalachian voice.

Harmony for Hope (H4H) Board of Directors — fiduciary oversight and regulatory compliance.

Financial Plan

Revenue Model

The Commons generates revenue through the same fee engine as MountainShares, once Phase 1 commerce is live:

- **Load Fee:** 2.85% (USD to M$)
- **Merchant Fee:** 1.80% on eligible M$ transactions
- **Internal Transfer Fee:** 0.25%
- **Revenue Allocation:** 30% to H4H Operations; 30% to Treasury Reserve; 25% split between Community Programs (15%) and Community Projects (10%).

Use of Funds

The 30,000 seed-funding request for Phase 0/1 covers:

Category	Estimated Cost
ALLIS node hardware (FCCAC proof-of-concept)	~$12,000
SKLink mesh / satellite backhaul	~$6,000
App development (front-end red-team ready)	~$7,000
Community Champion onboarding and ground-truthing	~$3,000
Legal / BSA compliance review	~$2,000
Total Year 1 Seed Ask	**~$30,000**

Longer-term hardware procurement (full corridor-scale ALLIS cluster) carries a cost ceiling of **$40,000**, targeted for the October 2027 milestone, contingent on ARC, USDA Rural Development, or Department of Energy grant awards.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf

Sources of Funds

- **Founder In-Kind Investment:** $796,200 (5,308 hours @ $150/hr) — serves as non-dilutable equity and critical grant match.
- **Year 1 Seed Raise:** $30,000 from H4H, community foundations, or small state innovation grants.
- **Federal & Foundation Grants:** Appalachian Regional Commission, USDA Rural Development, Department of Energy.
- **Academic Partnerships:** WVU collaborative research grants for AI validation and resilience modeling.
- **Self-Sustaining Fee Engine:** Transaction fees from Phase 1 commerce, scaling through Phase 3.
- **Appalachian Premium / Diaspora Storefront:** USD purchases from WV out-migrants supporting home communities.MountainShares-Business-Plan-19-Apr-2026x.pdf